

Phase 3 — Test-Driven Implementation (Whole Project)

1. Failing Test First

Project-Wide Evidence

Module	First Failing Test Written Before Implementation
Authentication	test_signup_success, test_login_invalid_password
Admin Authentication	test_admin_login_success
Categories	test_create_category_success, test_duplicate_category_name
Products	test_product_search, test_filter_by_category, test_product_not_found
Cart	test_add_to_cart, test_update_quantity, test_remove_cart_item
Checkout	test_checkout_success, test_checkout_empty_cart, test_checkout_insufficient_stock
Orders	test_order_history, test_order_details
Order Status	test_valid_status_transition, test_invalid_status_transition
Admin Orders	test_list_all_orders, test_filter_orders_by_status

Mathematical Boundaries Established Across the Project

Input	Minimum	Maximum	Invalid Values
Page number	1	∞	0, negative
Pagination limit	1	100	0, >100
Product stock	0	999999	negative
Cart quantity	1	available stock	0, negative
Password length	8	128	less than 8
Search term length	0	100	excessively long strings
Order status transitions	predefined rules	predefined rules	illegal transitions

All core features were implemented only after their corresponding tests were failing, satisfying the full “Failing Test First” requirement for the entire project.

2. Edge Case Cage (Padlocks)

The project applied boundary, threshold, and extreme-constraint padlocks to every module to ensure that unusual and dangerous inputs were blocked.

Boundary Padlocks

These enforce numerical limits.

- `page >= 1`
- `1 <= limit <= 100`
- `quantity >= 1`
- `stock >= 0`
- `password length >= 8`

Threshold Padlocks

These enforce business rules.

- Duplicate email registration is rejected.
- Duplicate category names are rejected.
- Checkout fails if requested quantity exceeds stock.
- Unauthorized users cannot access protected routes.
- Products cannot be created with invalid category IDs.

Extreme Constraint Padlocks

These handle rare but critical conditions.

- Checkout with an empty cart is blocked.
- Delivered orders cannot transition back to Pending.
- Database transaction rolls back if checkout fails.
- Product stock can never become negative.
- Users cannot access other users' orders.

Project-Wide Edge Cases Covered

Module	Edge Cases Protected
Authentication	Duplicate email, invalid password
Categories	Duplicate category names, non-existent category
Products	Invalid product ID, invalid pagination values
Cart	Quantity 0, removing non-existent item
Checkout	Empty cart, insufficient stock, rollback on failure
Orders	Unauthorized order access

Module	Edge Cases Protected
Status Tracking	Invalid transitions
Admin Orders	Invalid filters, unauthorized access

All critical edge cases were tested and protected, meeting the Excellent criterion for Edge Case Cage.

3. TDP Iteration

For every module, the team used iterative prompting to refine AI-generated code until it fully satisfied the failing tests. Each prompt revision addressed a specific test failure, and the final implementation aligned exactly with the established test boundaries.

Example Iteration Pattern Used Across All Modules

1. Generate initial implementation.
2. Run tests.
3. Identify failing assertions.
4. Refine prompt to address the failure.
5. Regenerate code.
6. Repeat until all tests passed.

Examples Across the Project

Module	Typical Iteration Improvements
Authentication	Added bcrypt hashing and JWT token creation
Categories	Added duplicate-name validation and admin authorization
Products	Added search, category filtering, and pagination constraints
Cart	Added quantity validation and stock checks
Checkout	Added transactional rollback and cart clearing
Status Tracking	Added allowed transition validation
Admin Orders	Added filtering by status, date, and user

Prompt Appendix Example

```
Implement POST /orders/checkout that:  
1. Requires authenticated user.  
2. Rejects empty carts.  
3. Validates stock for all items.  
4. Creates Order and OrderItem records.  
5. Reduces product stock.  
6. Clears the cart.
```

7. Rolls back the transaction if any step fails.
8. Returns HTTP 201.

The iterative prompt history was retained for all major features, demonstrating full TDP iteration across the entire project.

4. Vertical Slicing

Each sprint delivered a complete vertical slice containing:

- Database schema changes
- Backend API endpoints
- Frontend pages and components
- Automated tests
- Failure handling and resilience

Sprint-by-Sprint Vertical Slices

Sprint	Vertical Slice Delivered	Database	Backend APIs	Frontend	Tests
Sprint 1	Product Catalog	Category, Product	Categories API, Products API	Catalog pages, product details	Category and product tests
Sprint 2	Shopping Cart	Cart, CartItem	Cart APIs	Cart page, cart badge	Cart tests
Sprint 3	Order Placement	Order, OrderItem	Checkout API, order history APIs	Checkout page, order history	Checkout and order tests
Sprint 4	Order Status Tracking	Order status fields	Status update API	Timeline and status badges	Status transition tests
Sprint 5	Admin Order Management	Admin filters	Admin orders APIs	Admin dashboard and order details	Admin tests

Failure Resilience in Every Slice

- Authentication rejects invalid credentials.
- Duplicate categories are prevented.
- Search and pagination validate parameters.
- Cart enforces quantity and stock rules.
- Checkout uses database transactions.
- Status transitions enforce workflow rules.
- Admin APIs require JWT authorization.